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Doctoral Studies

Brandeis University
Ph.D., International Economics and Finance, Expected completion 2027
Dissertation: "*Essays on Expectations and Monetary Policy*"

Dissertation Committee and References

Professor Raphael Schoenle
Department of Economics
Brandeis University
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Professor George J. Hall
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Professor Jean-Paul L'Huillier
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Brandeis University
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Prior Education

Brandeis University
M.A., International Economics and Finance 2024
The Ohio State University
M.A., Economics 2019
El Colegio de México
M.S., Economics 2016
Thesis: *Optimal Simple Monetary Policy Rules and Equilibrium Determinacy under Informality*
Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México (UNAM)
B.A., Economics (*Summa cum laude*) 2012
Thesis: *Monetary Policy Rules: Analytical Frameworks and the Mexican Case, 2001–2011*

Citizenship Mexico

Languages Spanish (native), English (fluent)

Fields

Primary Fields: Monetary Economics, Macroeconomics
Secondary Field: Behavioral Macroeconomics

Teaching Experience

Brandeis University

Principles of Macroeconomics (undergraduate, ECON 20a) — 2025, 2026
Lecturer (primary instructor)

Macroeconomic Theory (undergraduate, ECON 82b) — 2023, 2024
Lecturer (primary instructor)

Inflation Dynamics and Monetary Policy (undergraduate) — 2026
Teaching Assistant

Macroeconomic Theory (undergraduate, ECON 82b) — 2022, 2026
Teaching Assistant

Financial Crisis (graduate) — 2024
Teaching Assistant

El Colegio de México

Macroeconomics and Microeconomics (M.S. in Economics) — 2016–2017
Teaching Assistant

Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México (UNAM)

Monetary Theory and Financial Policy (undergraduate) — 2014
Lecturer

Macroeconomics (undergraduate) — 2013–2014
Teaching Assistant

Relevant Positions

Research Assistant to Professor Raphael Schoenle, Brandeis University — 2024–2025

Research Assistant to Professor Lúcio Vinhas de Souza, Brandeis University — 2024

Research Assistant to Professor Aldo Musacchio, Brandeis University — 2022–2023

Deputy Director of Research, Ministry of Finance of Mexico — 2021–2022

Research Fellow, Center for Economic Studies, El Colegio de México — 2016–2018

Fellowships, Honors, and Awards

El Colegio de México

Josué Sáenz Award for Best Master's Thesis — 2016

Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México (UNAM)

Honorific Mention for Excellence — 2012

Computer Skills

MATLAB, R, Python, LaTeX

Research Papers

"Target-Based Communication under Credibility-Distorted Beliefs" (Job Market Paper)

Angeletos and Sastry (2021) theoretically show that central bank (CB) target-based communication anchors inflation expectations better than its interest rate counterpart. However, more UK households report adjusting their expectations based on the interest rate, they under-react to new information, and experienced inflation lowers credibility among the cohorts that have lived through the strongest inflationary episodes. This raises

the question of whether intensively investing in target-based communication would anchor expectations and deliver welfare improvements in this context. I explore it by proposing an expectation mechanism that unifies experience-based expectations with endogenous credibility, distorted by the diagnostic expectations of Bordalo, Gennaioli and Shleifer (2018), and incorporate it into a Representative Agent (RANK) and a Heterogeneous Agent (HANK) New Keynesian model. The main findings are: (i) while in the RANK model the welfare loss is entirely due to distorted expectations, in the HANK model the burden shifts from the older cohorts, who remember differently, towards the younger cohorts, who spend differently; (ii) a policy fully focused on communicating the target is unequivocally superior in reducing the loss for all cohorts; and (iii) target communication and traditional monetary policy are complements in the RANK model and substitutes in the HANK model. Therefore, target-based communication is a highly effective tool to anchor expectations when credibility is eroded, which CBs could implement more intensively with ample welfare gains.

"Unanchoring Regimes under Social Learning"

Inflation expectations become unanchored quickly but re-anchor slowly. Using microdata from the Bank of Mexico's Survey of Professional Forecasters, I measure anchoring as the probability mass forecasters place on the target range and document that re-anchoring after the post-2020 inflation episode proceeded at roughly one fifth of the speed of unanchoring. I build a New Keynesian model in which forecasters learn socially and in which the credibility of the target switches endogenously between anchored and unanchored regimes when forecasters detect persistent same-signed forecast errors. Rational expectations, cognitive discounting, and diagnostic expectations fail to generate any unanchoring episode; social learning generates episodes with the frequency and persistence seen in the data, because belief drift and credibility loss reinforce each other. Estimating the model by simulated method of moments, I find a Brainard-type prescription for caution: because the central bank cannot separate fundamental inflation from expectation drift, responding to inflation more aggressively than a standard Taylor coefficient reduces the time spent unanchored but raises output volatility by more than it gains in anchoring.

"Sticky Information Meets Wealth in Utility: Implications for Monetary Policy"

This paper extends the New Keynesian model by incorporating Sticky Information and Wealth in Utility (the SIWUNK model), to address its implications for the design of monetary policy. This paper demonstrates that equilibrium determinacy can be achieved under a Taylor rule even with a passive monetary stance, while price-level rules require both information frictions and a discrete inflation response. The transmission of monetary policy is modified, since agents' preference for wealth and delayed information processing extend the effects of shocks, requiring prolonged periods of low interest rates. Welfare analysis reveals that inflation targeting becomes more desirable than price-level targeting when wealth enters utility, even when price-level targeting performs better in the New Keynesian model.

Finally, despite the information frictions, optimal policy rules remain robust, though wealth in the utility function could shift the central bank preference towards output stabilization.

"Monetary Policy Surprises, Central Bank Information, and the Distribution of Inflation Expectations: Evidence from Mexico"

This paper studies how identified monetary policy shocks and central bank information shocks affect the full distribution of private-sector inflation expectations in Mexico. I adapt the Jarociński and Karadi (2020) sign-restriction VAR to Banxico announcements, decomposing high-frequency surprises in TIIE futures and the IPC BMV into pure monetary policy and central bank information components. I then estimate individual Beta distributions from the Encuesta de Expectativas del Sector Privado, extracting analyst-level moments (mean, variance, skewness) and a credibility index. Using local projections on a panel of analysts, I find that: (i) contractionary monetary policy shocks persistently reduce mean inflation expectations; (ii) positive central bank information shocks raise them; (iii) both shocks affect skewness in opposite directions; and (iv) monetary policy shocks gradually improve perceived credibility with a lag. Banxico's own inflation forecasts operate through a distinct channel, with the slope of the forecast path strongly associated with credibility levels.

"State-Dependent Pricing, Firm Heterogeneity, and the Slope Puzzle"

Why is the Phillips curve nearly flat in normal times yet steep during shocks? Using the micro price quotes underlying the U.K. consumer price index from 1996 to 2025, I document that large national retail chains are under four percent of firms but roughly seventy percent of the consumption basket, adjust prices almost four times as often as independent local retailers, and account for the overwhelming majority of the increase in the slope of the price-change relationship during crises. A menu-cost model in which firms differ in their exposure to aggregate shocks reproduces about seventy percent of the observed increase in the slope, with chains driving the bulk of the effect. The time-varying slope is a matter of who is adjusting, so the rising concentration of retail is itself a determinant of inflation dynamics.

Research in Progress

"Is a Dual Mandate Optimal under Informality and Capacity Constraints?"

I extend the two-sector New Keynesian model with informality to include an occasionally binding capacity constraint on formal employment, so that the informal sector absorbs the workers the formal sector cannot hire. Following the notion of effective room of L'Huillier and Schoenle, I compare the output stabilization a central bank intends to achieve when it raises the weight on output in its policy rule, as a standard New Keynesian model predicts, with the stabilization it effectively obtains once workers can move into informality. Preliminary results show that informality opens a wedge between the two: the central bank obtains only part of the intended reduction in output volatility, the wedge widens as the weight on output rises, and

the cost in inflation volatility is considerably larger than in the benchmark. A dual mandate therefore buys less stabilization and costs more inflation in an economy with a large informal sector.